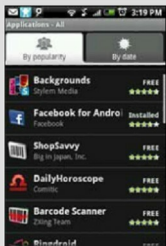
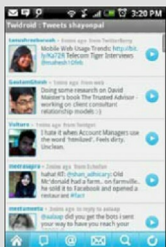


▲ Android Market Place



▲ Various applications at the Market Place



▲ Twidroid - Best Twitter app for Android

sunlight, it is pretty useless under low lighting conditions, thanks to the lack of a flash and low sensitivity. Moreover, the camera lens has no cover glass, thus making the lens slot a deadly magnet for dust.

Battery

Personally, for an Internet junkie like me, 1350mAh of juice is too little to even last a day. After about 30 minutes of YouTube, 30 Twitter updates, 10 FB updates, around 60 minutes of phone calls, 50 e-mail messages, 10 camera shots and 10 hours of Wi-Fi, the phone hardly lasted 20 hours. Ideally, I would have liked it to last for a minimum of 30 hours. However, the fact that I can charge the phone using the USB cord, never made me cry for battery power.

Performance

HTC Hero has a Qualcomm processor that causes the graphic transitions to stutter a bit and results in screen rotations that feel dangerously uncomfortable. Yet, we found the Hero to be stable, and it rarely hung or crashed. But the occasional lag could get annoying when you're using the phone every day. Moreover, the OS still seems to be a little unstable and asks us to force the closure of a certain *htc.android.provider* task quite frequently.

User experience

It is the home screen of HTC Hero that is unique among phones. There are seven home screens that you

can swap with the swipe of a finger, and you can add a range of widgets and shortcuts, as well as customise the wallpaper. This feature definitely gives you the feel of using multiple desktops on your computer.

The widgets make life so much more exciting with HTC Hero. While the widgets are homologous to Android, there are a host of them developed by HTC. What's more, if you find yourself limited, you can always browse at Android's Market Place and choose between thousands of free apps to download and use.

Surfing the Web on the Hero is a pleasure. Thanks to its accurate browser, which includes Flash support, you won't miss a single whizzy ad. Moreover, the multi-touch capability of the capacitive screen helps you zoom in and out of the Web pages, images and text really fast.

We also loved the 'Mount' feature of the phone that allows you to use the mobile's memory card as a USB drive.

Social network in your pants!

Hero is very tightly integrated with your Gmail, Facebook and Twitter contacts and makes sure you never miss 'updates' from your friends. The customised OS also pulls in your Facebook and Flickr photo albums and shows them alongside your contacts' info. If you click on a contact, it lists out not just the phone numbers, addresses and birthdays but also your friend's photos and updates on Twitter, Facebook and Flickr.



Figure 7: The innards of HTC Hero - in its full glory